

PMF Loop: Recruiter Confidence

THE MERIT FLYWHEEL

Recruiters use structured proof to make faster, more confident shortlist decisions. Every decision teaches the system what good looks like. Signal compounds. Opportunity expands.

MERIT CORE OBJECTS

 **PASSPORT**
A public proof profile of ability and potential.

 **PROOF CARD**
Evidence of work, skills, outcomes, and impact.

 **MATCH RATIONALE**
Why this candidate fits, explained clearly.



DATE	03 JUN 2026
STAGE	PMF FOCUS
VERSION	1.0

WHAT WE MEASURE



SPEED TO SHORTLIST
How fast recruiters move from role to confident shortlist.

- Time to shortlist
- Roles to shortlist
- Candidates reviewed per role
- Shortlist rate per batch



CONFIDENCE DELTA
How much more confident recruiters are after seeing structured proof.

- Confidence before vs after
- Rationale clarity score
- Evidence completeness
- Interview intent rate



REPEAT RECRUITER DEMAND
Do recruiters return and expand usage over time?

- Return rate (2nd role or more)
- More candidates requested
- Paid pilots / LOIs / Budget
- Referrals to other hiring owners

Recruiter Review Workspace

Review proof. Understand fit. Shortlist with confidence.

Share role brief

Export shortlist

Run new search

ROLE BRIEF

Edit

Product Design Intern

📅 Internship 📍 Singapore (Hybrid) 📅 May – Aug 2025

WHAT YOU'LL OWN

Support product designers in user research, wireframing, prototyping, and design iteration for early-stage products.

MUST-HAVE

Figma Wireframing User Research Prototyping
Design Systems Usability Testing

NICE TO HAVE

Illustration Motion Front-end Basics

FILTERS

Clear all

Skills

📄

Figma X Wireframing X User Research X

School / University

Search school...

Grad Year

2024 2027+

Location

Singapore

More filters

>

Save search

42 candidates found ⓘ

Sorted by Overall Fit ▾

	CANDIDATE	TARGET ROLE	PROOF STRENGTH (Relevance)	EVIDENCE (Completeness)	STATUS
1	 Jia Lin Ng NUS ✓	Product Design Intern Target	92 Excellent	88 Strong	☆ Top Match ⋮
2	 Marcus Tan SUTD ✓	Product Design Intern Target	88 Strong	80 Strong	+ Shortlist ⋮
3	 Priya Mehta NTU ✓	UX Design Intern Similar	84 Strong	68 Moderate	+ Shortlist ⋮
4	 Darren Lim SMU ✓	Product Design Intern Target	80 Strong	60 Moderate	+ Shortlist ⋮
5	 Aisha Rahman NUS ✓	Product Designer Similar	72 Good	56 Moderate	Review more ⋮
6	 Ethan Koh SIT ✓	UI/UX Intern Similar	68 Good	40 Limited	Review more ⋮
7	 Rachel Wong TP ✓	Product Design Intern Target	64 Good	36 Limited	Review more ⋮

Showing 1–7 of 42 candidates

< 1 2 3 4 5 >

SELECTED CANDIDATE

✕



Jia Lin Ng ✓

National University of Singapore
Final Year, Information Systems

📍 Singapore ✉ jialin.ng@u.nus.edu

OVERALL FIT
92
Excellent

WHY THIS CANDIDATE FITS

- ✔ Strong end-to-end product design thinking demonstrated in 3 projects
- ✔ Deep Figma skills with component systems and auto-layout
- ✔ User research and usability testing with measurable outcomes
- ✔ Portfolio shows iteration, feedback loops, and cross-functional impact

STRONGEST PROOF CARD

[View all projects \(5\)](#)



CampusConnect – Student Hub Redesign

Product Design • Feb – Apr 2025

Redesigned student experience for timetables, events, and notifications with a design system.*

End-to-end Design Figma User Research Prototyping

30+ User Interviews | 82% Task Success | 2x Onboarding Speed

EVIDENCE

-  Figma Prototype (Interactive) [View](#) [🔗](#)
-  Usability Test Summary [View](#) [🔗](#)
-  Before / After Screenshots [View](#) [🔗](#)

MISSING SIGNAL

- ⚠ No front-end implementation
- ⚠ Design system documentation
- ⚠ Impact beyond prototype
- ⚠ Team collaboration evidence

+ Shortlist

Request clarification

...

Shortlisted by Rui Tan • Today, 10:24 AM

Proof Card Anatomy

A RECRUITER-READABLE VIEW OF STUDENT WORK, SKILLS, AND IMPACT.

WHY THIS MATTERS TO RECRUITERS

- Artifact Preview**
See the work in context before you invest time.
- What Was Built**
Understand the project scope and purpose quickly.
- Candidate Contribution**
Clarifies what the candidate actually did, not just what the team built.
- Skills Demonstrated**
Maps skills to real execution, not just claimed keywords.
- Evidence Artifacts**
Inspect the proof. Click through. Verify for yourself.
- Outcome / Impact**
Shows results, users, or measurable impact.
- Role Relevance**
Why this project matters for this role.
- Confidence Gaps**
Highlights what's missing so you can assess risk fast.

1

2

3

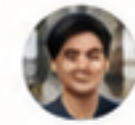
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5

6

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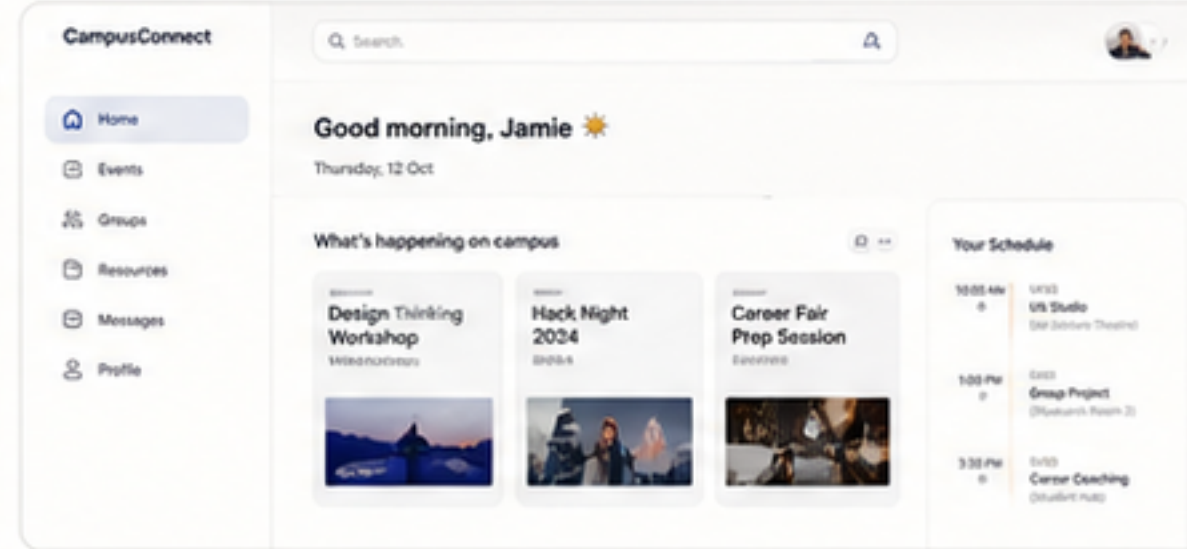


Aidan Tan
Product Designer
Singapore Management University

VERIFIED

Passport Score
86 / 100

Available for
Internship, Full-time



CampusConnect — Student Hub Redesign

Centralized platform for events, resources, and community.

Project Type

UX/UI Design



What Was Built

A responsive web experience that helps students discover events, manage schedules, join communities, and access resources in one place.



Candidate Contribution

Led end-to-end UX process: user research, IA, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, prototype, usability testing, and design system.



Skills Demonstrated

User Research Information Architecture UI Design Prototyping Usability Testing Design Systems



Evidence Artifacts

Figma Prototype (Interactive) User Flow (PDF) Usability Report (PDF) Design System (Figma)



Outcome / Impact

+40% Task Success Rate -28% Time to Find Events 85 / 100 Usability Score 5 Usability Test Participants



Role Relevance

This project demonstrates end-to-end product design for a user-facing platform, strong problem framing, and ability to deliver tested solutions — directly relevant to junior product design roles.



Confidence Gaps

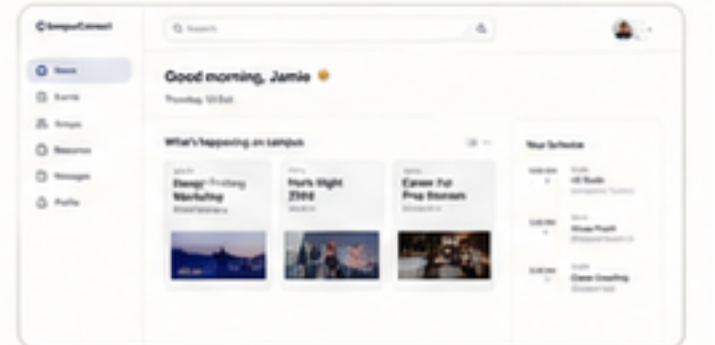
- Limited exposure to production handoff and developer collaboration
- No backend integration in this project
- Larger user base validation needed

STRONG SIGNAL

Structured Proof Card



Aidan Tan
Product Designer
SMU
86 / 100
Passport Score



CampusConnect — Student Hub Redesign

- Built** Student hub platform for events, resources, communities.
- Role** Led UX research, IA, UI, prototype, testing, design system.
- Skills** Research · IA · UI · Prototyping Usability · Design Systems
- Evidence** +4
- Impact** +40% task success rate -28% time to find events 85/100 usability score
- Fit for Role** Strong alignment with junior product design roles.
- Gaps** Handoff experience, backend integration, larger-scale validation.

Clear proof.
Confident shortlist.

01

DAYS 1-21

RECRUITER DISCOVERY

OBJECTIVE

Identify the narrow recruiter segments with the sharpest early-career hiring pain.

KEY ACTIONS

Interview 20 recruiters / hiring owners

Collect last-hire artifacts: resumes, portfolios, job descriptions, rubrics

Map screening pain, trusted signals, and unusable signals

Identify which proof types matter per role

SUCCESS METRIC

Top 3 recruiter ICPs with active hiring pain and willingness to review candidates.

DECISION GATE

Continue only with segments where recruiters show active hiring pain and willingness to review candidates.

02

DAYS 22-45

CONCIERGE PROOF MATCHING

OBJECTIVE

Prove recruiters can shortlist candidates faster through Merit-style proof.

KEY ACTIONS

Select 5 recruiter partners

Each submits 1 real role

Manually curate 10 candidates per role

Prepare structured proof summaries

Run live review sessions

Measure confidence & shortlist decisions

SUCCESS METRIC

≥30% of reviewed candidates are shortlisted or seriously considered.

DECISION GATE

If <30% shortlisted, the proof structure or candidate supply is not strong enough yet.

03

DAYS 46-65

STUDENT PROOF QUALITY

OBJECTIVE

Improve supply quality based on recruiter feedback.

KEY ACTIONS

Convert recruiter feedback into proof checklist

Identify 30 high-potential students

Each improves 1 proof card

Review before/after with recruiters

Track what changes increase confidence

SUCCESS METRIC

Recruiters mark more proof cards as "clear evidence" and confidence rises.

DECISION GATE

If students cannot produce stronger proof with simple guidance, onboarding and templates need redesign.

04

DAYS 66-90

REPEAT BUYER LOOP

OBJECTIVE

Show repeat demand and willingness to pay.

KEY ACTIONS

Ask initial recruiters for 2nd role or batch

Offer paid pilot / LOI

Track recruiter willingness to pay for: curated batch, workspace, contact unlocks, shortlist support

Capture testimonials on confidence, speed, and proof quality

SUCCESS METRIC

≥5 recruiters return or request another batch; ≥3 pay or sign LOI.

DECISION GATE

Next build cycle is based on repeated recruiter behavior, not founder intuition.

PMF SCORECARD

RATE 0-5 (HIGHER IS BETTER)

RECRUITER PULL

Retention and buying intent from recruiters.

2.5

/5

STUDENT SUPPLY QUALITY

Quality, clarity, and recruiter-readiness of student proof.

2.0

/5

MARKETPLACE READINESS

Repeatable loop, patterns, and infrastructure readiness.

1.5

/5

0-1 EARLY

2-3 PROGRESS

4-5 STRONG

NORTH STAR

Recruiter-qualified shortlists created from structured proof.

DEFINITION

A recruiter-qualified shortlist is a set of candidates a recruiter says they would interview or seriously consider after reviewing Merit proof.

WHY THIS MATTERS

When recruiters can shortlist with more confidence and speed, they return. When they return, students with real ability get discovered.

KEY INPUT METRICS

#

Students with complete proof

#

Roles submitted

#

Curated sets delivered

#

Recruiter review sessions

#

Shortlists created

CONFIDENCE DELTA

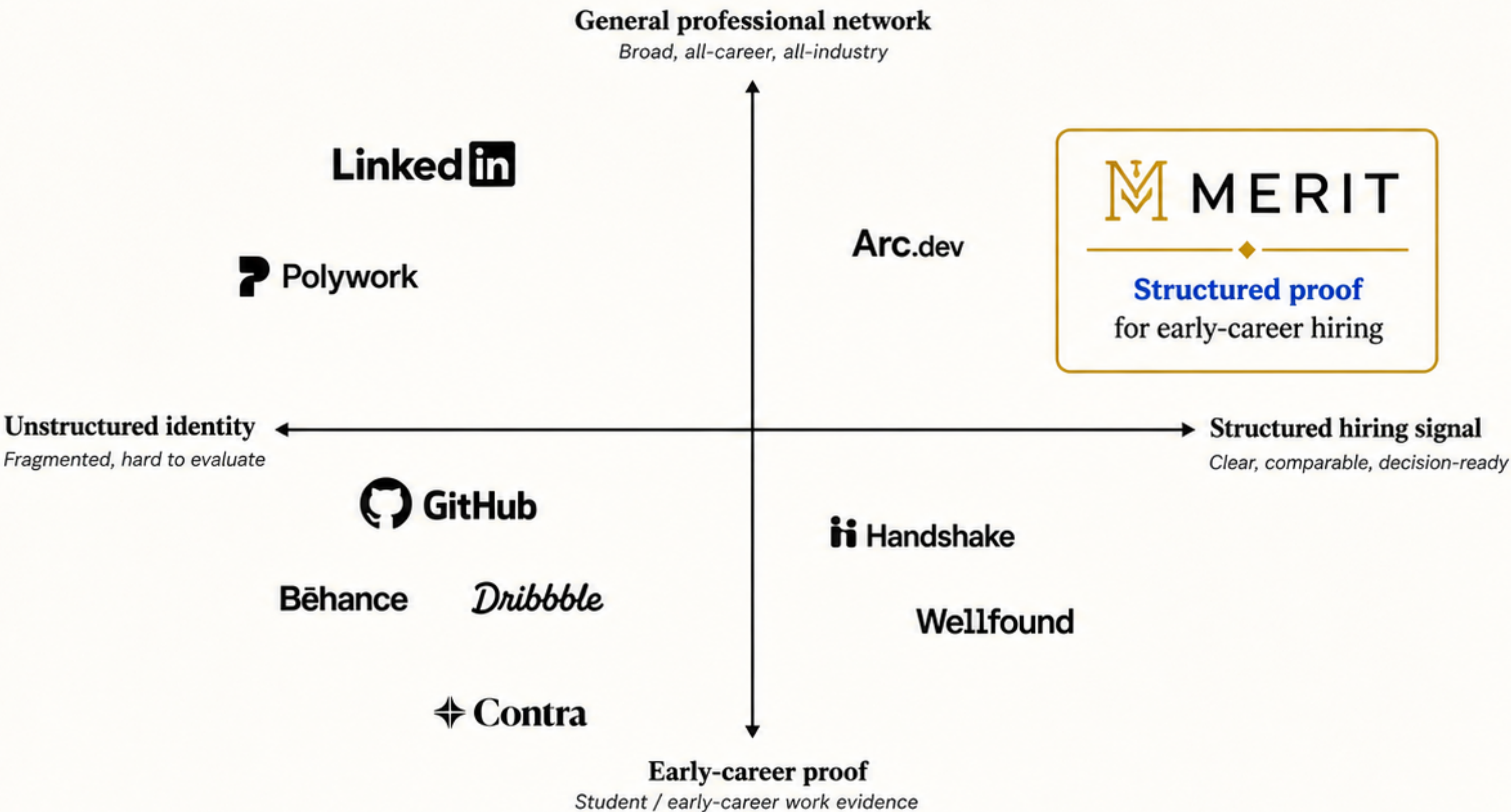
+X.X

Avg recruiter confidence before vs after proof

Where Merit Wins

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING MAP

MERIT
PROOF OVER PEDIGREE



POSITIONING INSIGHTS



LinkedIn = graph
Largest professional graph.
Broad coverage, weak early-career proof.



Handshake = campus access
Strong early-career network through schools and events.
Limited proof depth.



GitHub = code proof
Best-in-class for developers.
Narrow to code, not full candidate context.



Behance/Dribbble = visual showcase
Great for creatives.
Showcase-first, not hiring context.



Wellfound/Arc = hiring marketplace
Marketplace + outreach.
Focus on roles, not proof interpretation.



Merit = proof interpretation
Structured proof → role fit → recruiter understanding.

● NETWORK PLAY ● PROOF / SHOWCASE PLAY ● MARKETPLACE PLAY ● MERIT DIFFERENTIATOR

◆ Do not compete on network size first. Compete on recruiter understanding. ◆

Student Activation: Strongest Proof First

A recruiter-readable journey that starts with intent, not a profile.



Guidance

Do not ask students to complete a profile first. Ask what role they want and what work proves it.

- 1 Choose target role**
Tell us the role you want.
We'll tailor your proof.
- 2 Pick strongest project**
Select the project that best proves you can do this role.
- 3 Explain your contribution**
Make your role, impact, and skills clear to recruiters.
- 4 Attach evidence**
Show recruiters real proof they can see and trust.
- 5 Publish Passport**
Your proof is now live for recruiters to discover.

What role are you targeting?

Suggested roles

- Product Designer Intern ✓
- UX Designer Intern
- Frontend Developer Intern
- Growth Marketing Intern
- Data Analyst Intern

Your passport will be optimized for this role.

Your projects [+ Add project](#)

- Nova Mobile App**
★ **Strongest match**
Product Design
- Campus Buddy Platform**
Web Application
- Brand Redesign**
Visual Identity

Not seeing it? [Add another project.](#)

Your role & impact

What was your role?
Product Designer

What did you do?
Led end-to-end product design for a mobile study planner. Conducted user research, created wireframes, high-fidelity UI, and prototype. 118/300

What was the outcome?
Increased task completion by 35% in usability tests with 12 users. 60/150

Skills demonstrated

- User Research
- Wireframing
- UI Design
- Prototyping
- Figma
- Design Systems

Evidence & artifacts
Add at least one strong artifact.

- Hi-Fi Prototype** Primary
Figma Prototype
- Case Study**
PDF • 2.4 MB
- User Test Summary**
PDF • 1.1 MB
- Prototype Link**
<https://www.figma.com/proto/...>

[+ Add more evidence](#)
or drag and drop files

Preview your passport [Public](#)

Jia Tan
Product Designer
Singapore

- Product Designer Intern
- View passport
- Share link

[Publish Passport](#)

BEFORE: Empty profile with generic fields

Student User
Student
Singapore

- Add headline
- Add bio
- Add skills
- Add projects
- Add experience
- Add education
- Add links

Headline Add your headline	Bio Tell us about yourself
Skills Add your skills	Experience Add your experience
Projects Add your projects	Education Add your education

AFTER: Recruiter-readable passport with one complete Proof Card

Jia Tan
Product Designer
Singapore

- Product Designer Intern
- Open to opportunities
- Passport link
- Contact available

PROOF CARD

Best match for Product Designer Intern

Nova Mobile App
Study planner mobile app for university students

MY ROLE
Product Designer
Led end-to-end design from research to hi-fi prototype.

SKILLS DEMONSTRATED
User Research Wireframing
UI Design Prototyping
Design Systems

OUTCOME
+35%
Increase in task completion in usability tests (12 users).

EVIDENCE
 Hi-Fi Prototype
 Case Study (PDF)
 User Test Summary
 Prototype Link

WHY IT MATTERS FOR THIS ROLE
Demonstrates user-centered design, structured problem solving, and ability to ship end-to-end product experiences.

CONFIDENCE SIGNALS
 Real users tested
 Measurable outcome
 End-to-end ownership

92
Proof Score

Student PMF = my work finally looks **credible** to recruiters.

Proven by work.

Merit turns student projects into recruiter-readable proof, so early talent can be evaluated beyond the resume.

[Build your passport](#)

For students

[Review proof as recruiter](#)

For recruiters

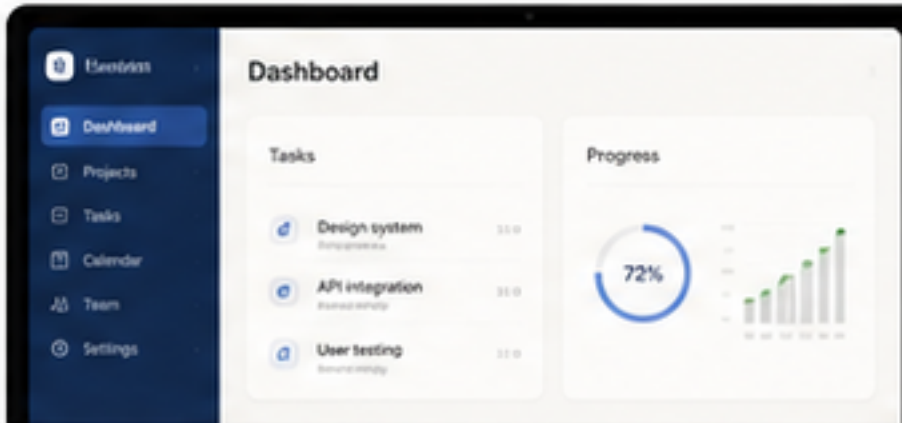
Built for early talent. Backed by proof.

[Verified people](#) |
 [Real work](#) |
 [Recruiter-first](#) |
 [Privacy by design](#)

PROOF CARD

Nebula Task Manager Web App

A collaborative task management platform built for student teams.



MY ROLE
Full-stack Developer

WHAT I DID
Built auth, tasks API, real-time updates

TECH USED





OUTCOME
Used by 120+ students across 3 faculties

SKILLS DEMONSTRATED
[TypeScript](#)
[React](#)
[Node.js](#)
[PostgreSQL](#)

EVIDENCE  Live demo • [GitHub repo](#) • [Docs](#) • [User feedback](#) Verified 

★ RECRUITER SHORTLIST

Product Intern

Singapore • Internship • 3–6 months

5 Strong matches

CANDIDATE	PROOF SIGNALS	FIT SCORE	ACTION
N Nicole Tan View passport	- Full-stack project - Real users - Impact metrics	92 Strong fit	Shortlist 
J Jasper Lim View passport	- API development - Clean code - Docs & testing	86 Strong fit	Shortlist 
A Aisha Rahman View passport	- Product thinking - User research - Design + build	82 Strong fit	Shortlist 
D Daniel Koh View passport	- Backend systems - Database design - Performance	78 Good fit	Shortlist 
M Marcus Yee View passport	- Frontend build - Component design - Testing	73 Good fit	Shortlist 

Shortlist summary 3 shortlisted

[Contact selected](#)

Work
You build.

Proof
You show it.

Signal
We interpret it.

Opportunity
You get discovered.



For students

Turn your work into a proof passport.

- Showcase real projects with context
- Get recruiter-readable feedback signals
- Stand out beyond GPA and pedigree

[Build your passport](#) →

Profile completeness 85%

- Add project 
- Add role & goals 
- Add evidence 
- Add impact 



For recruiters

Find and trust early talent faster.

- Search by role, skills, and proof signals
- Review structured proof in minutes
- Shortlist with confidence and clarity

[Review proof](#) →

Proof signals

- Technical depth 
- Problem solving 
- Execution quality 
- Impact 

Confidence High



For PMF

We measure what matters.

- Recruiter confidence delta
- Shortlist and interview conversion
- Proof quality and feedback loops

[See the PMF plan](#) →

PMF scorecard

